School of Engineering

College of Arts and Sciences

WiSeMAN Research Lab Organizes

Fall 2026 International Distinguished Lecture Series

Towards Secure 5G and beyond Networks

Distinguished Speaker: Dr. Anna Tzanakaki

Professor, OPTICA Speakership Jane Simmons Award

National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Greece

Date: October 15, 2026

Time: 10:00 am – 11:00 am

Venue: Online

Abstract: Current 5G network deployments face a range of security risks that are expected to be significantly amplified with the transition towards 6G. The increasing adoption of open and disaggregated solutions, such as O-RAN, highlights the need for enhanced interoperability and standardization driven by well-defined security objectives. At the same time, advanced 6G capabilities—including highly flexible network configurations and emerging service models such as Integrated Sensing and Communication (ISAC)—introduce new and more complex security challenges. Future 6G infrastructures will therefore require security-oriented architectures that embrace zero-trust principles. Moreover, their inherent complexity will necessitate AI-enabled automation to manage vast volumes of operational data while ensuring strong guarantees for data privacy, security, and trust. In this context, AI/ML techniques will play a central role not only in performance optimization, but also in enabling secure and resilient operation, supported by advanced monitoring capabilities and effective cybersecurity threat intelligence sharing across multi-vendor and multi-operator environments.

Speaker's Biography: Anna Tzanakaki is a Professor at the National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Greece where she is leading the "Systems and Networks" Research Group. Previously she was an Associate Professor at the Athens Information Technology (AIT) Center, Greece and an adjunct faculty member of the Information Networking Institute of Carnegie Mellon University, USA. Her research interests include network architectures and design and over the past 10 years has focused on 5G and 6G infrastructures. She has been and is actively participating in a number of EU research projects, has served as the technical coordinator of the 5G PPP projects 5G-PICTURE and 5G-VICTORI, and is currently the Project and Technical coordinator of the EU DEP projects 5G-TACTIC and CTIS4NIS focusing on 5G Security. She is a co-author of over 250 publications and co-inventor of several granted and published patents. She is the recipient of the OPTICA Jane Simmons speakership award 2024 for her contribution to optical and converged network research.



All Faculty, Staff, and Students are most welcome to attend this exciting talk!

For more information about this Fall 2026 International Distinguished Lecture Series, please contact Prof. Habib M. Ammari (Endowed Professor of Computer Engineering, Founding Coordinator) at Habib.Ammari@tamiu.edu